INT. UNIVERSITY LIBRARY STUDY ROOM - NIGHT

Laptops, empty energy drink cans. PRIYA (19) stares at a whiteboard covered in equations. MARCUS (19) bursts in, phone in hand.

MARCUS
You didn't answer the group chat.

PRIYA
(not looking up)
I muted the group chat.

MARCUS
Forty messages, Priya. They're saying you're dropping the project.

Priya caps her marker. Slowly.

PRIYA
I'm not dropping the project. I'm dropping you guys.

CONTINUED:

MARCUS
That's... that's the same thing.

He sets his phone face down on the table.

MARCUS (CONT'D)
(quieter)
Was it something I did?

A long beat. Priya finally turns to face him.

PRIYA
You told them it was your idea.

His phone buzzes. He doesn't look at it.

MARCUS
I panicked.

PRIYA
You presented.

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